

YEP Field Sediment Collection Protocol

Materials:

- 2-0.5 L bottles
- 2-metal spoons
- 2-metal scoopulas
- 2-2mm sieves and catch pans
- Cooler with ice
- Gloves

Prep before going to the field:

1. Peroxide rinse 2 metal spoons, 2 spatulas, and two sieves
 - a. Milli-Q water rinse 3 times, soak in 3% hydrogen peroxide for 15 minutes, rinse again 3 times with milli-q water.
2. Acid rinse 2-0.5 L bottles
 - a. Soak in .1M HCl for 4 hours, rinse 3 times with milli-Q water.
 - b. Label them for the collection of dry and wet sediments.

Field collection:

1. Locate two locations for sediment sampling. The “dry” sediment location should have been dry for several weeks, and the “wet” sediment location should be collected underwater from the riverbed.
2. Use the scoopula to remove plant material and larger (>4mm) debris from the ground surface, clearing the area above the sediment.
3. Put on a new pair of nitrile gloves to be used for sediment collection.
4. Use the spoon to transfer sediment material from 3 cm below the surface into the sieve.
5. Use the spoon to work/push sediments through the sieve until the larger materials separate out.
6. Remove the sieve from the catch pan and homogenize the sediment in the catch pan before transferring it to the appropriately labelled 0.5L bottle.
7. Fill sample bottle, moving horizontally across the depositional zone if necessary to collect similar sediment.
8. Store the sediment bottles on ice in the cooler.
9. Fill out the field metadata sheet.